

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 26 Summary

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In this lesson, we focus on how to use pronominal verbs—those that end in *-se* in the infinitive—with the Spanish patterns you already know, such as *tener que + infinitive*, *querer + infinitive*, *ir a + infinitive*, and *poder + infinitive*.

Rather than jumping into full conjugation charts, we work around conjugation by plugging pronominal verbs into these familiar patterns. The key is to adjust the reflexive pronoun (the *se* part) to match the subject.

Reflexive Pronouns Refresher:

- *me* – myself (*yo*)
 - *te* – yourself (*tú*)
 - *se* – himself, herself, yourself (formal) (*él, ella, usted*)
 - *nos* – ourselves (*nosotros*)
 - *os* – yourselves (*vosotros*)
 - *se* – themselves, yourselves (*ellos, ellas, ustedes*)
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Common Pronominal Verbs Used in This Lesson:

- **acostarse** – to go to bed / lie down
 - **despertarse** – to wake up
 - **levantarse** – to get up
 - **bañarse** – to bathe / shower oneself
 - **lavarse** – to wash oneself
 - **sentarse** – to sit down
 - **quejarse de** – to complain about
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Example Patterns with Pronominal Verbs

1. Tener que + infinitive

Just attach the correct reflexive pronoun to the infinitive:

- *Tengo que acostarme.* = I have to go to bed.
- *Tienes que levantarte.* = You have to get up.
- *Tenemos que bañarnos.* = We have to take a shower.

2. Querer + infinitive

Same process. Change the reflexive pronoun to match the subject:

- *Quiero despertarme a las seis.* = I want to wake up at six.
- *¿Quieres sentarte aquí?* = Do you want to sit here?

3. Ir a + infinitive

Use this for talking about what someone is going to do:

- *Voy a acostarme temprano.* = I'm going to go to bed early.
- *¿Vas a bañarte?* = Are you going to take a shower?

4. Poder + infinitive

Used for asking permission or ability:

- *¿Puedo lavarme las manos?* = Can I wash my hands?
- *¿Puedo sentarme aquí?* = Can I sit here?

Body Part Reminder

When using pronominal verbs with body parts, use definite articles (*el, la, los, las*), not possessive adjectives:

- *Voy a lavarme las manos.* = I'm going to wash my hands.
- *Tienes que lavarte los dientes.* = You have to brush your teeth.

This keeps your Spanish sounding natural and avoids redundancy.

Using “quejarse de”

Some pronominal verbs always include a preposition. One great example is:

- *quejarse de* – to complain about
Examples:
 - *Quiero quejarme del tráfico.* = I want to complain about the traffic.
 - *Carlos se queja de todo.* = Carlos complains about everything.

Always learn these verbs with the preposition included so you can plug them into your patterns with confidence.

Final Thoughts

This lesson was all about making pronominal verbs easier by working them into the patterns you already know. You don't have to conjugate every verb to start using them. Just focus on:

- Picking the right reflexive pronoun
- Attaching it to the infinitive
- Plugging everything into a structure you've already practiced

Over time, this will become second nature—just like solving a math problem you've already worked through once.